



Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading

2026 Released Test Items

How the Rosetta Stone unlocked the secrets of ancient civilizations

by Erin Blakemore

1 When Pierre-François Bouchard’s men discovered the ancient stone slab that would change the world on July 19, 1799, they weren’t on an archaeological dig; they were doing a last-minute construction job. The French soldiers occupied a run-down fort in Rosetta, Egypt, and had just days to shore up their defenses for a battle with Ottoman Empire troops.

2 As the men tore down a wall that had been built using the detritus¹ of nearby ancient Egyptian sites, they discovered a large stone fragment covered in three types of writing, including ancient Greek. Intrigued, Bouchard wondered if the stone might say the same thing in three different languages. He shared his find with French scholars who had come to plumb Egypt for archaeological treasures.

3 They got more than they bargained for. The slab was the Rosetta Stone, and the letters and symbols carefully chiseled into its dark face would shed light on the glory of ancient Egyptian civilization. But first, scholars would have to crack its code.

A decree of loyalty

4 Standing at about four feet high and 2.5 feet wide, the granite-like rock is just a fragment of a larger, now lost, stele. But though its text is incomplete, it is invaluable. It consists of a decree affirming the royal cult of Ptolemy V Epiphanes, an Egyptian king who took the throne in 204 B.C.

5 At the time, the Ptolemaic kingdom was at war and dealing with an internal revolt. The decree was passed by a council of priests who used it to honor the pharaoh and declare their loyalty to him. It was recorded on the stele in Ptolemaic hieroglyphics, Demotic Egyptian script, and ancient Greek script. Identical stelae were to be placed in every temple in Egypt.

Conquering scholars

6 Fast-forward to 1798, when Napoleon led French forces to take over Egypt, which was then part of the Ottoman Empire. Scientists and historians were part of the conquering force, and streamed into the country to document what they found there. The Egyptologists gathered a large number of ancient artifacts they wanted to take back to France, including the Rosetta Stone.

¹detritus: pieces that are left when something breaks apart

- 7 But the British wanted Egypt, too, and in 1801 they prevailed over French forces. The French were allowed to evacuate, but the British demanded they hand over the antiquities collection before leaving. So in 1802 the Rosetta Stone made its way to London, where it was put on display at the British Museum almost immediately upon arriving.

The Rosetta Stone's code

- 8 But the stone had more than aesthetic² value. Scholars had long puzzled over the meaning of the picture-like markings, known as hieroglyphs, made on ancient Egyptian slabs. Since it contained identical content in three languages, scholars thought the Rosetta Stone might be able to help crack the historic mystery.
- 9 Scholars raced to translate the Rosetta Stone. Though a variety of scholars across Europe would contribute to the work, the two most important contributions came from England and France.
- 10 Thomas Young, a British polymath best known for his scientific contributions, treated the mystery as a mathematical problem. After translating the ancient Greek, he took extensive notes on the hieroglyphs and systematically attempted to match each one to its translation. He also compared the glyphs to those on other statues. Young was able to identify the phonetic sounds some glyphs represented, figure out some of the characters, and piece together how words were pluralized.
- 11 But it was Jean-François Champollion, a Frenchman known as the founder of Egyptology, who would ultimately crack the code in 1822. Where Young had no experience with the Egyptian language, Champollion was fluent in Coptic³ and had extensive knowledge about Egypt. He figured out that the demotic⁴ script—the third writing system on the stele—conveyed syllables and that the hieroglyphs represented Coptic sounds.
- 12 It was a breakthrough. Famously, an ecstatic Champollion rushed into his brother's office shouting "*Je tiens mon affaire!*" ("I've got it!"). Then he fainted and did not recover for five days.

The Rosetta Stone's legacy

- 13 Champollion used the stone to create an alphabet of phonetic hieroglyphic characters, then other scholars piggybacked on his research to fully translate the stone. The French Egyptologist's work

²aesthetic: relating to art or beauty

³Coptic: a language of ancient Egypt

⁴demotic: popular or common

was eventually validated by the discovery and translation of the Decree of Canopus, another stele written in hieroglyphs, demotic script, and ancient Greek.

- 14 The Rosetta Stone's translation became the backbone of Egyptology, and the iconic stele has been credited as one of the most important objects in history. But the stone itself is controversial as a spoil of war and colonial expansion. Was the Rosetta Stone taken to England or stolen by the British? That depends on who you ask. Over the years, there have been repeated calls to return the stone to Egypt, but it remains at the British Museum, where it has over six million visitors a year.
- 15 Why does the plain-looking Rosetta Stone retain such a luster today, two centuries after its code was cracked? Egyptologist John Ray told *Smithsonian Magazine's* Beth Py-Lieberman in 2007 that the stone "is really the key, not simply to ancient Egypt; it's the key to decipherment itself. We knew there were big civilizations, like Egypt, but they'd fallen silent. With the cracking of the Rosetta Stone, they could speak with their own voice and suddenly whole areas of history were revealed."

"How the Rosetta Stone unlocked the secrets of ancient civilizations" by Erin Blakemore. Copyright © 2021 by National Geographic. Reprinted by permission of National Geographic via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. How does the section header **Conquering scholars** contribute to the development of ideas in the passage?
- Ⓐ It suggests there were financial intentions behind translating the text.
 - Ⓑ It highlights how academic discovery was tied to the struggle for the stone.
 - Ⓒ It reveals the education that the soldiers of the time were expected to have.
 - Ⓓ It introduces the idea that the text needed to be translated to be understood.

2. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What are **two** central ideas about the Rosetta Stone in the passage?

- Ⓐ It was taken to England after it was first discovered.
- Ⓑ Others like it were placed in temples throughout Egypt.
- Ⓒ It enabled researchers to discover more about the past.
- Ⓓ It created a valuable opportunity for a scholar from France.
- Ⓔ Scholars used it in order to learn how hieroglyphic writing works.

Part B

Which sentence from the passage connects the two ideas in Part A?

- Ⓐ "He shared his find with French scholars who had come to plumb Egypt for archaeological treasures." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "The Egyptologists gathered a large number of ancient artifacts they wanted to take back to France, including the Rosetta Stone." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓒ "But it was Jean-François Champollion, a Frenchman known as the founder of Egyptology, who would ultimately crack the code in 1822." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓓ "The Rosetta Stone's translation became the backbone of Egyptology, and the iconic stele has been credited as one of the most important objects in history." (paragraph 14)

3. Read this sentence from the passage.

"The French were allowed to evacuate, but the British demanded they hand over the antiquities collection before leaving." (paragraph 7)

The meaning of the Latin root *ante-* is "before." Based on this information, what is the meaning of the word antiquities?

- Ⓐ objects surviving from long ago
- Ⓑ objects that have been recreated
- Ⓒ objects featuring different languages
- Ⓓ objects that have already been taken

- 4.** Read this sentence from the passage.

"Intrigued, Bouchard wondered if the stone might say the same thing in three different languages." (paragraph 2)

What is the meaning of intrigued as it is used in the sentence?

- Ⓐ angered
- Ⓑ disappointed
- Ⓒ fascinated
- Ⓓ satisfied

5. Read the excerpt from the passage.

“Why does the plain-looking Rosetta Stone retain such a luster today, two centuries after its code was cracked?” (paragraph 15)

What is the significance of the figurative language “retain such a luster” in this excerpt?

- Ⓐ It indicates how well people have preserved the stone.
- Ⓑ It explains the specific information revealed by the stone.
- Ⓒ It shows how some people wonder about the stone’s future.
- Ⓓ It suggests that the stone’s attraction goes beyond translation.

- 6.** This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the author's purpose in paragraphs 11–12?

- Ⓐ to establish the significance of the discovery
- Ⓑ to reveal how the ancient languages are used today
- Ⓒ to tell about the men who first discovered the Rosetta Stone
- Ⓓ to provide details about the kinds of ancient objects found in Egypt

Part B

What does the author do to support the purpose in Part A?

- Ⓐ describes Champollion's strong work ethic
- Ⓑ points out the time period Champollion lived in
- Ⓒ describes the languages Champollion had mastered
- Ⓓ points out Champollion's excitement about his success

7. How does the section **A decree of loyalty** contribute to the development of ideas in the passage?
- Ⓐ It recounts how the stone was finally discovered.
 - Ⓑ It presents different interpretations of the writing on the stone.
 - Ⓒ It offers background information about the purpose of the stone.
 - Ⓓ It explains how people are still looking for similar stones in other places.

Hearts and Hands

by O. Henry

This story takes place on a passenger train in the western United States in the early 1900s. Around this time, traveling by train was the most reliable and popular way to travel long distances.

1 At Denver there was an influx of passengers into the coaches on the eastbound B. & M. express. In one coach there sat a very pretty young woman dressed in elegant taste and surrounded by all the luxurious comforts of an experienced traveler. Among the newcomers were two young men, one of handsome presence with a bold, frank countenance and manner; the other a ruffled, glum-faced person, heavily built and roughly dressed. The two were handcuffed together.

2 As they passed down the aisle of the coach the only vacant seat offered was a reversed one facing the attractive young woman. Here the linked couple seated themselves. The young woman's glance fell upon them with a distant, swift disinterest; then with a lovely smile brightening her countenance and a tender pink tingeing her rounded cheeks, she held out a little gray-gloved hand. When she spoke her voice, full, sweet, and deliberate, proclaimed that its owner was accustomed to speak and be heard.

3 "Well, Mr. Easton, if you will make me speak first, I suppose I must. Don't you ever recognize old friends when you meet them in the West?"

4 The younger man roused himself sharply at the sound of her voice, seemed to struggle with a slight embarrassment which he threw off instantly, and then clasped her fingers with his left hand.

5 "It's Miss Fairchild," he said, with a smile. "I'll ask you to excuse the other hand; it's otherwise engaged just at present."

6 He slightly raised his right hand, bound at the wrist by the shining "bracelet" to the left one of his companion. The glad look in the girl's eyes slowly changed to a bewildered horror. The glow faded from her cheeks. Her lips parted in a vague, relaxing distress. Easton, with a little laugh, as if amused, was about to speak again when the other forestalled him. The glum-faced man had been watching the girl's countenance with veiled glances from his keen, shrewd eyes.

7 "You'll excuse me for speaking, miss, but, I see you're acquainted with the marshal here. If you'll ask him to speak a word for me when we get to the pen he'll do it, and it'll make things easier for me there. He's taking me to Leavenworth prison. It's seven years for counterfeiting."

- 8 "Oh!" said the girl, with a deep breath and returning color. "So that is what you are doing out here? A marshal!"
- 9 "My dear Miss Fairchild," said Easton, calmly, "I had to do something. Money has a way of taking wings unto itself, and you know it takes money to keep step with our crowd in Washington. I saw this opening in the West, and—well, a marshalship isn't quite as high a position as that of ambassador, but—"
- 10 "The ambassador," said the girl, warmly, "doesn't call any more. He needn't ever have done so. You ought to know that. And so now you are one of these dashing Western heroes, and you ride . . . and go into all kinds of dangers. That's different from the Washington life. You have been missed from the old crowd."
- 11 The girl's eyes, fascinated, went back, widening a little, to rest upon the glittering handcuffs.
- 12 "Don't you worry about them, miss," said the other man. "All marshals handcuff themselves to their prisoners to keep them from getting away. Mr. Easton knows his business."
- 13 "Will we see you again soon in Washington?" asked the girl.
- 14 "Not soon, I think," said Easton. "My butterfly days are over, I fear."
- 15 "I love the West," said the girl irrelevantly. Her eyes were shining softly. She looked away out the car window. She began to speak truly and simply without the gloss of style and manner: "Mamma and I spent the summer in Denver. She went home a week ago because father was slightly ill. I could live and be happy in the West. I think the air here agrees with me. Money isn't everything. But people always misunderstand things and remain stupid—"
- 16 "Say, Mr. Marshal," growled the glum-faced man. "This isn't quite fair. . . . Haven't you talked long enough?" . . .
- 17 The bound travelers rose to their feet, Easton with the same slow smile on his face.
- 18 . . . "Good-bye, Miss Fairchild. Duty calls, you know." He held out his hand for a farewell.
- 19 "It's too bad you are not going East," she said, reclothing herself with manner and style. "But you must go on to Leavenworth, I suppose?"
- 20 "Yes," said Easton, "I must go on to Leavenworth."
- 21 The two men sidled down the aisle. . . .
- 22 The two passengers in a seat near by had heard most of the conversation. Said one of them: "That marshal's a good sort of chap. Some of these Western fellows are all right."

- 23 "Pretty young to hold an office like that, isn't he?" asked the other.
- 24 "Young!" exclaimed the first speaker, "why—Oh! didn't you catch on? Say—did you ever know an officer to handcuff a prisoner to his right hand?"

Excerpt from "Hearts and Hands" by O. Henry. In the public domain.

8. How does the historical setting impact the plot of the passage?

- Ⓐ It creates a conflict about women working on trains.
- Ⓑ It supports the attitudes of adventure about the West.
- Ⓒ It offers a comparison between people who travel often.
- Ⓓ It suggests the lack of possibilities for success in the West.

9. Complete the table to show how the different elements of the train affect character development in the passage.

	The Crowded Coach	The Long Journey	Both
allows characters to separate at different places	(A)	(B)	(C)
forces multiple characters into close contact	(D)	(E)	(F)
creates an environment different from what some characters are used to	(G)	(H)	(I)

10. How do the two questions in paragraph 24 affect the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ They reveal that Mr. Easton is a foolish man.
- Ⓑ They imply that the glum-faced man is truly guilty.
- Ⓒ They clarify that Mr. Easton is actually the prisoner.
- Ⓓ They suggest that the glum-faced man is a pitiful character.

11. How does the third-person narrator influence the passage?

- Ⓐ by describing the way that Miss Fairchild avoids Mr. Easton on the train
- Ⓑ by suggesting that Mr. Easton and Miss Fairchild both want to leave the West
- Ⓒ by hiding the true relationship between Mr. Easton and the glum-faced man until the end
- Ⓓ by providing conflicting knowledge of where Mr. Easton and the glum-faced man are traveling to

12. How does the passage develop the themes of enjoying the company of old friends and the fun of experiencing new places?

- Ⓐ through Miss Fairchild's discomfort at being in the marshal's presence
- Ⓑ through Mr. Easton's eagerness to learn about Miss Fairchild's family trip
- Ⓒ through Mr. Easton's reluctance to sit close to such an elegant passenger
- Ⓓ through Miss Fairchild's delight at chatting with Mr. Easton on her journey home

13. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What are **two** themes of the passage?

- Ⓐ Knowledge of the truth can bring freedom.
- Ⓑ Adventure is important to living a happy life.
- Ⓒ Material objects are desired by many people.
- Ⓓ Things can be different from how they appear.
- Ⓔ A simple conversation may contain hidden truths.

Part B

How does the author develop the themes in Part A?

- Ⓐ through the interactions of Mr. Easton, Miss Fairchild, and the glum-faced man
- Ⓑ through Miss Fairchild's reflection on the summer she spent exploring the West
- Ⓒ through the discussion of the glum-faced man's expectations of Leavenworth prison
- Ⓓ through the contrast between the destinations of Mr. Easton, Miss Fairchild, and the glum-faced man

- 14.** Select **two** details that show how the narrator suggests that Miss Fairchild is used to being treated well.
- Ⓐ "In one coach there sat a very pretty young woman dressed in elegant taste and surrounded by all the luxurious comforts of an experienced traveler." (paragraph 1)
 - Ⓑ "When she spoke her voice, full, sweet, and deliberate, proclaimed that its owner was accustomed to speak and be heard." (paragraph 2)
 - Ⓒ "'Oh!' said the girl, with a deep breath and returning color." (paragraph 8)
 - Ⓓ "'The ambassador,' said the girl, warmly, 'doesn't call any more.'" (paragraph 10)
 - Ⓔ "The girl's eyes, fascinated, went back, widening a little, to rest upon the glittering handcuffs." (paragraph 11)

Passage 1: Easy for you, tough for a robot

by Kathryn Hulick

1 “Robots are klutzes,” says Ken Goldberg. He’s an engineer and artificial intelligence (AI) expert at the University of California, Berkeley. A computer can easily defeat a human grandmaster at the game of chess by coming up with better moves. Yet a robot has trouble picking up an actual chess piece.

2 This is an example of Moravec’s paradox. Hans Moravec is a roboticist at Carnegie Mellon University in Pittsburgh, Penn., who also writes about AI and the future. Back in 1988, he wrote a book that noted how reasoning tasks that seem hard to people are fairly easy to program into computers. Meanwhile, many tasks that come easily to us—like moving around, seeing or grasping things—are quite hard to program.

3 It’s “difficult or impossible” for a computer to match a one-year-old baby’s skills in these areas, he wrote. Though computers have advanced by leaps and bounds since then, babies and kids still beat machines at these types of tasks.

4 It turns out that the tasks we find easy aren’t really “easy” at all. As you walk around your house or pick up and move a chess piece, your brain is performing incredible feats of calculation and coordination. You just don’t notice it because you do it without thinking.

5 Let’s take a look at several tasks that are easy for kids but not for robots. For each one, we’ll find out why the task is actually so hard. We’ll also learn about the brilliant work engineers and computer scientists are doing to design new AI that should help robots up their game.

Task 1: Pick stuff up

6 Goldberg has something in common with robots. He, too, is a klutz. “I was the worst kid at sports. If you threw me a ball, I was sure to drop it,” he says. Perhaps, he ponders, that’s why he wound up studying robotic grasping. Maybe he’d figure out the secret to holding onto things.

7 He’s discovered that robots (and clumsy humans) face three challenges in grabbing an object. Number one is perception. That’s the ability to see an object and figure out where it is in space. Cameras and sensors that measure distance have gotten much better at this in recent years. But robots still get confused by anything “shiny or transparent,” he notes. . . .

Task 2: Get around the world

8 If someone plops you down in the middle of a building you’ve never been in before, you might feel a bit lost. But you could look around,

find a door and get out of the room quickly without bumping into anything or getting stuck. Most robots could not do that. Researcher Antoni Rosinol first got interested in this problem while working with drones. Usually, someone pilots a drone via remote control. That's because most drones can't fly very well by themselves. "They can barely go forward without colliding against a tree," notes Rosinol. He is a PhD student studying computer vision at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in Cambridge.

- 9 Perception is a big problem for many navigating robots, just as it is for robots that grasp things. . . .

Task 3: Understand people

- 10 No matter what a robot tries to do, one big thing holds it back. Robots lack common sense. This is the knowledge that people don't have to think or talk about because it's so obvious to us. Thanks to common sense, you know that you should grab a lollipop by the stick and not by the candy. You know that doors are almost never located on the floor or ceiling. And so on.
- 11 Computer scientists have tried teaching robots common-sense rules. But even huge databases of these rules don't seem to help much. There are just too many rules and too many exceptions. And no computer or robot understands the world well enough to figure out these rules on its own. . . .
- 12 It's very likely that in the coming years someone will design a graceful robot or even an AI model with common sense. For now, though, if you want to beat a robot at chess, make it play on a real, physical chess board.

Excerpt from "Easy for you, tough for a robot" by Kathryn Hulick, from *Science News Explores*. Copyright © 2021 by Society for Science & the Public. Reprinted by permission of Society for Science & the Public via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: from *How Life Imitates Chess*

by Garry Kasparov

In 1996 and 1997, World Chess Champion Garry Kasparov played two chess matches against a supercomputer named Deep Blue, created by the company IBM. The matches placed Kasparov's intelligence against the computer's artificial intelligence.

- 13 After my first match with Deep Blue in 1996 in Philadelphia received so much publicity, IBM threw its full weight behind a six-game rematch in May 1997 to be held in downtown Manhattan. In 1996, I

lost the first game of the match, but after that wake-up call I came back to win three games and easily defeat the computer 4–2. For the rematch IBM claimed “Deeper Blue” was twice as fast and much smarter. They had hired human Grandmasters to work full-time “teaching” the computer by improving its evaluation function.

14 The media attention for the first game of the rematch was beyond that of a world championship. Over three hundred journalists were accredited, and the five-hundred-seat auditorium sold out at \$25 per ticket. Of course I was nervous. Being human, I was unable to ignore all of these distractions, unlike my silicon¹ opponent. But I played well enough to win the first game with white². The second game would, however, change the course of the match, and of human-machine competition.

15 I’ve talked about computers and their inability to make long-term plans. They calculate variations in a linear way, examining each move in turn, searching deeper and deeper. Even at Deep Blue’s 200 million moves per second, it took it a long time to see far enough ahead to play competent strategic chess. It would occasionally make silly moves no strong human would consider, and it did this in its loss in game one. Game two was an entirely different matter. . . . Instead of going for a short-term advantage, it closed in for the kill. Faced with a losing position and stunned by the godlike quality of the machine’s play, I resigned.

16 I soon received an even greater shock. It turned out that the final position of the second game was not a losing one for me after all. With its last move the computer had blundered, and I had resigned in a drawn position! It felt like being kicked in the stomach after already being knocked down. When I was shown the drawing line, I realized that I would have continued on against any human. . . .

17 I missed a clear win in the fourth game, and by then I was exhausted and confused. Was something fishy going on, or was Deep Blue really so strong? In the fifth game I again missed good winning chances, so the match remained tied with one win apiece and three draws. Everything was set for a showdown in game six, but looking back today, I see my fate had already been sealed.

18 It took only nineteen moves for me to resign the worst game of my career and lose the match. I was simply in no condition to play chess by that point, and I made an infantile blunder in the opening. After a few more feeble moves the game and the match were over. I was ashamed of my performance and for letting the mysterious second game get to me.

¹silicon: a chemical element used to make many electronic devices

²white: in chess, game pieces are white or black in color

Excerpt from *How Life Imitates Chess: Making the right moves, from the board to the boardroom* by Garry Kasparov. Copyright © 2007 by Garry Kasparov. Reprinted by permission of Bloomsbury USA via Copyright Clearance Center.

15. Select **two** details where the author’s word choice reveals a negative view toward the abilities of robots.

- 6 Ⓐ Goldberg has something in common with robots. He, too, is a klutz. Ⓑ “I was the worst kid at sports. If you threw me a ball, I was sure to drop it,” he says. Ⓒ Perhaps, he ponders, that’s why he wound up studying robotic grasping. Ⓓ Maybe he’d figure out the secret to holding onto things.
- 7 Ⓔ He’s discovered that robots (and clumsy humans) face three challenges in grabbing an object. Ⓕ Number one is perception. Ⓖ That’s the ability to see an object and figure out where it is in space. Ⓗ Cameras and sensors that measure distance have gotten much better at this in recent years. Ⓢ But robots still get confused by anything “shiny or transparent,” he notes. . . .

- 16.** How does the author develop an argument against robot intelligence in paragraph 10 of Passage 1?
- Ⓐ by suggesting that robots are only able to copy what they see humans do
 - Ⓑ by describing how robots complete tasks in more difficult ways than humans do
 - Ⓒ by explaining ways in which humans are taught to overcome unfamiliar situations
 - Ⓓ by providing examples of how humans can do certain things without being taught

17. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“We’ll also learn about the brilliant work engineers and computer scientists are doing to design new AI that should help robots up their game.” (paragraph 5)

How does the figurative language in this sentence impact the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It indicates that people are finding ways to make robots better.
- Ⓑ It demonstrates the fun that people can have while using robots.
- Ⓒ It emphasizes the amount of effort that goes into building robots.
- Ⓓ It suggests that people who build robots compete with one another.

18. How does the author of Passage 1 support the claim that robots struggle at tasks that are easy for humans?

- Ⓐ by citing experts and their experiences working with robots
- Ⓑ by demonstrating how experts use robots in their personal lives
- Ⓒ by describing how experts feel while creating robots that perform simple tasks
- Ⓓ by identifying experts and their paths to becoming respected in the field of robotics

19. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“I’ve talked about computers and their inability to make long-term plans.” (paragraph 15)

Match the correct meaning of the prefix, root, and suffix to define the word inability as it is used in this sentence.

	in-	abil	-ity
power	(A)	(B)	(C)
lack of	(D)	(E)	(F)
the state of	(G)	(H)	(I)

20. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“It felt like being kicked in the stomach after already being knocked down.” (paragraph 16)

How does the figurative language in this sentence impact the tone of the passage?

- Ⓐ It develops a sense of chaos.
- Ⓑ It creates a feeling of jealousy.
- Ⓒ It highlights the feeling of tension.
- Ⓓ It emphasizes the sense of defeat.

- 21.** Why does the author of Passage 2 use the phrase “‘teaching’ the computer” in paragraph 13?
- Ⓐ to reveal the amount of time it takes to set up computers
 - Ⓑ to reveal the data collected from the development of computers
 - Ⓒ to highlight how computers can help people develop useful skills
 - Ⓓ to emphasize that computers must be programmed in order to advance

22. Read these sentences from Passage 2.

“I missed a clear win in the fourth game, and by then I was exhausted and confused. Was something fishy going on, or was Deep Blue really so strong?” (paragraph 17)

How does the author’s use of the phrase “something fishy going on” in paragraph 17 add to Passage 2?

- Ⓐ by indicating that he had considered trying to trick Deep Blue
- Ⓑ by showing how impressed he was by Deep Blue’s physical power
- Ⓒ by expressing how overwhelmed he was by Deep Blue’s playing abilities
- Ⓓ by suggesting that he became uninterested in playing against Deep Blue

23. Passage 2 develops these two central ideas.

1. The human brain has a limit.
2. Technology is able to make humans question their abilities.

How does the author develop these two ideas?

- Ⓐ by identifying the skills required to play chess successfully
- Ⓑ by describing how interested the public was in the matches
- Ⓒ by explaining how Deep Blue was trained before the rematch
- Ⓓ by stating the outcomes of various chess games with Deep Blue

24. How does paragraph 18 contribute to the meaning of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ It emphasizes the annoyance the author felt toward Deep Blue.
- Ⓑ It reveals the plan Deep Blue followed in order to win the match.
- Ⓒ It stresses the humiliation that the author felt after losing to Deep Blue.
- Ⓓ It compares the strategies that Deep Blue and the author used during the match.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading

25. Complete the table to show whether each perspective about robot capabilities applies to Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
Robots can accomplish amazing things.	(A)	(B)	(C)
Robots can surprise people by outsmarting them.	(D)	(E)	(F)
Robots lack the common sense that humans have.	(G)	(H)	(I)

Passage 1: The Lighthouse Birds

- 1 Thick mist from the ocean sprayed on the breeze as Aurora walked down the rickety boardwalk. In the distance, outlined against the frothy white waves of the sea, stood a large red lighthouse. Well, the color resembled a chewed piece of bubble gum now, long since faded and washed out from the sun. The wooden boardwalk leading to the building had seen better days, too. Aurora didn't mind—she'd journey anywhere to capture a good story.
- 2 “No wonder they want to tear this place down—it’s not exactly easy on the eyes,” her co-editor Harrison complained, sidestepping what was once someone’s picnic lunch.
- 3 Aurora sighed as they drew closer to the lighthouse. “Honeydew Lighthouse used to be the most gorgeous place on Honeydew Key. Did you know they built it in 1920? It’s over a hundred years old.”
- 4 “What happened to it?” Harrison asked, eyebrows raised in disbelief. Aurora had to admit, looking at the lighthouse now, it was hard to believe it was ever a shining beacon of the community, attracting tourists for its unbeatable views of the sea.
- 5 “As the town grew, new tourist attractions popped up—there’s that outlet mall, and the miniature golf course. I guess people are more interested in those things,” Aurora said sadly.
- 6 “Can you blame them?” Harrison asked. “Miniature golf is awesome, and this lighthouse is, well . . .” He trailed off, clearly not wanting to hurt Aurora’s feelings.
- 7 Harrison’s disdain for the lighthouse only reminded Aurora of the email she’d received a few days ago from the keeper of the Honeydew Lighthouse.

Aurora,

I read all your news stories in the local paper. I ask that you write a piece imploring the city to reconsider tearing down Honeydew Lighthouse. It is a cornerstone of history, and it deserves to remain standing.

Best,

William Washington

- 8 She had walked out of her office after reading the email and walked down to the beach to think. The rough, sandy shore and salty air helped clear her mind. Whenever she was feeling stumped, the crystal blue water gave her clarity and reminded her why she so deeply loved Honeydew Key.

- 9 Pulling out her phone, she began researching ideas for how to save the lighthouse. She considered starting a petition or trying to get the lighthouse named a historic landmark. There was no guarantee that either of those approaches would be successful, however, and they would be time-consuming, dragging on for months, if not years. Aurora wasn't sure she had that kind of time. They could save the lighthouse if there were endangered or protected animal species living there, but that seemed unlikely.
- 10 No, her best approach would be to talk to Mr. Washington in person and rally the town's support. This is how she ended up dragging Harrison reluctantly down the boardwalk toward Honeydew Lighthouse. She now noticed Mr. Washington at the top, attempting to repaint the peeling sides. He waved to Aurora and Harrison before suddenly disappearing into the lighthouse. When the pair reached the base of the building, a small door swung open. "Thank you both for coming," Mr. Washington said as he ushered them inside.
- 11 As the group climbed the creaking staircase, the trilling sound of birds echoed off the walls. "Since the city has allocated its budget to renovate the downtown area for tourists, there is no money for me to restore Honeydew Lighthouse."
- 12 The sound of birds grew louder the higher they climbed, and Harrison showed Aurora a face that screamed, "Seriously? You want to save a place overrun by birds?"
- 13 "This lighthouse is the reason for the town. Before all this new technology, it was the only way to guide ships," Mr. Washington explained proudly.
- 14 As they reached the top of the lighthouse, the source of all the bird noise came into view. About a dozen white birds roosted around the ceiling, feathers ruffling in the ocean breeze.
- 15 "I recognize that bird," Harrison said excitedly, "It's a Roseate Tern—did you know that they're endangered?"
- 16 Silence fell over the group as sudden realization dawned on Aurora.
- 17 "Harrison, you may not love this lighthouse, but you are a genius!"
- 18 "I am?" His nose scrunched in confusion, unaware of what he had done.
- 19 "I know how to write my news article. We can save Honeydew Lighthouse!"

"The Lighthouse Birds" written for educational purposes.

Passage 2: Do Not Go Gentle Into That Good Night

by Dylan Thomas

- 1 Do not go gentle into that good night,
Old age should burn and rave at close of day;
Rage, rage against the dying of the light.
- 5 Though wise men at their end know dark is right,
Because their words had forked no lightning they
Do not go gentle into that good night.
- Good men, the last wave by, crying how bright
Their frail deeds might have danced in a green bay,
Rage, rage against the dying of the light.
- 10 Wild men who caught and sang the sun in flight,
And learn, too late, they grieved it on its way,
Do not go gentle into that good night.
- Grave men, near death, who see with blinding sight
Blind eyes could blaze like meteors and be gay,
15 Rage, rage against the dying of the light.
- And you, my father, there on the sad height,
Curse, bless, me now with your fierce tears, I pray.
Do not go gentle into that good night.
Rage, rage against the dying of the light.

"Do Not Go Gentle Into That Good Night" by Dylan Thomas. Copyright © 1957 by New Directions Publishing Corporation. Reprinted by permission of New Directions Publishing Corporation via Copyright Clearance Center.

26. How would Passage 1 address the story differently if it were told from the point of view of Harrison?

- Ⓐ by describing the scenery where the lighthouse is located
- Ⓑ by identifying what makes the lighthouse special to the community
- Ⓒ by showing how the age of the lighthouse means it should be updated
- Ⓓ by explaining that there are good reasons for tearing down the lighthouse

27. Complete the table to match each rhetorical device from Passage 1 with its meaning.

	Pleasant to Look At	In Older and Poor Condition	Experiencing Confusion
"had seen better days" (paragraph 1)	(A)	(B)	(C)
"easy on the eyes" (paragraph 2)	(D)	(E)	(F)
"feeling stumped" (paragraph 8)	(G)	(H)	(I)

28. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“This is how she ended up dragging Harrison reluctantly down the boardwalk toward Honeydew Lighthouse.” (paragraph 10)

The word “reluctant” is from a Latin root that means “to struggle.” Based on this information, what does the word reluctantly mean in this sentence?

- Ⓐ in an unwilling or hesitant way
- Ⓑ with feelings of anger or despair
- Ⓒ with eagerness to take on a challenge
- Ⓓ in confusion caused by unclear directions

- 29.** Complete the table to show how the features of the setting affect the plot of Passage 1.

	Contributes to the Main Problem	Provides the Solution
The lighthouse is old and in need of repair.	Ⓐ	Ⓑ
An endangered bird species lives at the lighthouse.	Ⓒ	Ⓓ
The town has other attractions that are more popular than the lighthouse.	Ⓔ	Ⓕ

30. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

"I ask that you write a piece imploring the city to reconsider tearing down Honeydew Lighthouse." (paragraph 7)

What is the meaning of the word imploring as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ admiring
- Ⓑ begging
- Ⓒ enclosing
- Ⓓ visiting

31. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“Since the city has allocated its budget to renovate the downtown area for tourists, there is no money for me to restore Honeydew Lighthouse.”
(paragraph 11)

What is the meaning of the word allocated in this sentence?

- Ⓐ cast doubt upon
- Ⓑ set aside for a purpose
- Ⓒ sacrificed in a quick decision
- Ⓓ borrowed without expecting repayment

32. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What does the setting of Passage 1 reveal about William Washington?

- Ⓐ his skill in conducting research
- Ⓑ his hesitation in asking for help
- Ⓒ his pride in protecting the lighthouse
- Ⓓ his exhaustion from working by himself

Part B

Which sentence from Passage 1 supports the answer in Part A?

- Ⓐ *"I read all your news stories in the local paper."* (paragraph 7)
- Ⓑ *"It is a cornerstone of history, and it deserves to remain standing."* (paragraph 7)
- Ⓒ "No, her best approach would be to talk to Mr. Washington in person and rally the town's support." (paragraph 10)
- Ⓓ "'Thank you both for coming,' Mr. Washington said as he ushered them inside." (paragraph 10)

- 33.** Complete the table to show whether the figurative language in the lines from Passage 2 describes youth or old age.

	Youth	Old Age
“caught and sang the sun in flight” (line 10)	Ⓐ	Ⓑ
“there on the sad height” (line 16)	Ⓒ	Ⓓ
“the dying of the light” (line 19)	Ⓔ	Ⓕ

34. How does the repetition of lines 1 and 3 throughout Passage 2 affect the meaning of the poem?

- Ⓐ It shows that the speaker is afraid of life's difficulties.
- Ⓑ It explains why the speaker wants to change his past choices.
- Ⓒ It describes doubts the speaker has about his father's decisions.
- Ⓓ It emphasizes the strength the speaker wants his father to have.

- 35.** Complete the table to match the details from the passages to how they develop the topic of refusing to give up.

	Encourages a person to show strength.	Takes inspiration from an opposing viewpoint.
“Harrison, you may not love this lighthouse, but you are a genius!” (Passage 1, paragraph 17)	(A)	(B)
“Old age should burn and rave at close of day;” (Passage 2, line 2)	(C)	(D)

36. How does the author of Passage 1 develop the topic of facing a challenge differently than the author of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ In Passage 1, Aurora fights on behalf of others, but in Passage 2, the speaker acts selfishly.
- Ⓑ In Passage 1, Aurora confronts a difficulty herself, but in Passage 2, the speaker is an observer.
- Ⓒ In Passage 1, Aurora works independently, but in Passage 2, the speaker joins a group of people.
- Ⓓ In Passage 1, Aurora feels troubled by her experiences, but in Passage 2, the speaker remains cheerful.



Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2026

How the Rosetta Stone unlocked the secrets of ancient civilizations

by Erin Blakemore

1 When Pierre-François Bouchard’s men discovered the ancient stone slab that would change the world on July 19, 1799, they weren’t on an archaeological dig; they were doing a last-minute construction job. The French soldiers occupied a run-down fort in Rosetta, Egypt, and had just days to shore up their defenses for a battle with Ottoman Empire troops.

2 As the men tore down a wall that had been built using the detritus¹ of nearby ancient Egyptian sites, they discovered a large stone fragment covered in three types of writing, including ancient Greek. Intrigued, Bouchard wondered if the stone might say the same thing in three different languages. He shared his find with French scholars who had come to plumb Egypt for archaeological treasures.

3 They got more than they bargained for. The slab was the Rosetta Stone, and the letters and symbols carefully chiseled into its dark face would shed light on the glory of ancient Egyptian civilization. But first, scholars would have to crack its code.

A decree of loyalty

4 Standing at about four feet high and 2.5 feet wide, the granite-like rock is just a fragment of a larger, now lost, stele. But though its text is incomplete, it is invaluable. It consists of a decree affirming the royal cult of Ptolemy V Epiphanes, an Egyptian king who took the throne in 204 B.C.

5 At the time, the Ptolemaic kingdom was at war and dealing with an internal revolt. The decree was passed by a council of priests who used it to honor the pharaoh and declare their loyalty to him. It was recorded on the stele in Ptolemaic hieroglyphics, Demotic Egyptian script, and ancient Greek script. Identical stelae were to be placed in every temple in Egypt.

Conquering scholars

6 Fast-forward to 1798, when Napoleon led French forces to take over Egypt, which was then part of the Ottoman Empire. Scientists and historians were part of the conquering force, and streamed into the country to document what they found there. The Egyptologists gathered a large number of ancient artifacts they wanted to take back to France, including the Rosetta Stone.

¹detritus: pieces that are left when something breaks apart

- 7 But the British wanted Egypt, too, and in 1801 they prevailed over French forces. The French were allowed to evacuate, but the British demanded they hand over the antiquities collection before leaving. So in 1802 the Rosetta Stone made its way to London, where it was put on display at the British Museum almost immediately upon arriving.

The Rosetta Stone's code

- 8 But the stone had more than aesthetic² value. Scholars had long puzzled over the meaning of the picture-like markings, known as hieroglyphs, made on ancient Egyptian slabs. Since it contained identical content in three languages, scholars thought the Rosetta Stone might be able to help crack the historic mystery.
- 9 Scholars raced to translate the Rosetta Stone. Though a variety of scholars across Europe would contribute to the work, the two most important contributions came from England and France.
- 10 Thomas Young, a British polymath best known for his scientific contributions, treated the mystery as a mathematical problem. After translating the ancient Greek, he took extensive notes on the hieroglyphs and systematically attempted to match each one to its translation. He also compared the glyphs to those on other statues. Young was able to identify the phonetic sounds some glyphs represented, figure out some of the characters, and piece together how words were pluralized.
- 11 But it was Jean-François Champollion, a Frenchman known as the founder of Egyptology, who would ultimately crack the code in 1822. Where Young had no experience with the Egyptian language, Champollion was fluent in Coptic³ and had extensive knowledge about Egypt. He figured out that the demotic⁴ script—the third writing system on the stele—conveyed syllables and that the hieroglyphs represented Coptic sounds.
- 12 It was a breakthrough. Famously, an ecstatic Champollion rushed into his brother's office shouting "*Je tiens mon affaire!*" ("I've got it!"). Then he fainted and did not recover for five days.

The Rosetta Stone's legacy

- 13 Champollion used the stone to create an alphabet of phonetic hieroglyphic characters, then other scholars piggybacked on his research to fully translate the stone. The French Egyptologist's work

²aesthetic: relating to art or beauty

³Coptic: a language of ancient Egypt

⁴demotic: popular or common

was eventually validated by the discovery and translation of the Decree of Canopus, another stele written in hieroglyphs, demotic script, and ancient Greek.

- 14 The Rosetta Stone's translation became the backbone of Egyptology, and the iconic stele has been credited as one of the most important objects in history. But the stone itself is controversial as a spoil of war and colonial expansion. Was the Rosetta Stone taken to England or stolen by the British? That depends on who you ask. Over the years, there have been repeated calls to return the stone to Egypt, but it remains at the British Museum, where it has over six million visitors a year.
- 15 Why does the plain-looking Rosetta Stone retain such a luster today, two centuries after its code was cracked? Egyptologist John Ray told *Smithsonian Magazine's* Beth Py-Lieberman in 2007 that the stone "is really the key, not simply to ancient Egypt; it's the key to decipherment itself. We knew there were big civilizations, like Egypt, but they'd fallen silent. With the cracking of the Rosetta Stone, they could speak with their own voice and suddenly whole areas of history were revealed."

"How the Rosetta Stone unlocked the secrets of ancient civilizations" by Erin Blakemore. Copyright © 2021 by National Geographic. Reprinted by permission of National Geographic via Copyright Clearance Center.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

1. How does the section header **Conquering scholars** contribute to the development of ideas in the passage?
- Ⓐ It suggests there were financial intentions behind translating the text.
 - Ⓑ It highlights how academic discovery was tied to the struggle for the stone.
 - Ⓒ It reveals the education that the soldiers of the time were expected to have.
 - Ⓓ It introduces the idea that the text needed to be translated to be understood.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey a purpose in texts.

2. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What are **two** central ideas about the Rosetta Stone in the passage?

- Ⓐ It was taken to England after it was first discovered.
- Ⓑ Others like it were placed in temples throughout Egypt.
- Ⓒ It enabled researchers to discover more about the past.
- Ⓓ It created a valuable opportunity for a scholar from France.
- Ⓔ Scholars used it in order to learn how hieroglyphic writing works.

Part B

Which sentence from the passage connects the two ideas in Part A?

- Ⓐ "He shared his find with French scholars who had come to plumb Egypt for archaeological treasures." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "The Egyptologists gathered a large number of ancient artifacts they wanted to take back to France, including the Rosetta Stone." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓒ "But it was Jean-François Champollion, a Frenchman known as the founder of Egyptology, who would ultimately crack the code in 1822." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓓ "The Rosetta Stone's translation became the backbone of Egyptology, and the iconic stele has been credited as one of the most important objects in history." (paragraph 14)

Answer Key: C, E and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Compare two or more central ideas and their development throughout a text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

3. Read this sentence from the passage.

“The French were allowed to evacuate, but the British demanded they hand over the antiquities collection before leaving.” (paragraph 7)

The meaning of the Latin root *ante-* is “before.” Based on this information, what is the meaning of the word antiquities?

- Ⓐ objects surviving from long ago
- Ⓑ objects that have been recreated
- Ⓒ objects featuring different languages
- Ⓓ objects that have already been taken

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 73%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

4. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Intrigued, Bouchard wondered if the stone might say the same thing in three different languages.” (paragraph 2)

What is the meaning of intrigued as it is used in the sentence?

- Ⓐ angered
- Ⓑ disappointed
- Ⓒ fascinated
- Ⓓ satisfied

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 80%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

5. Read the excerpt from the passage.

“Why does the plain-looking Rosetta Stone retain such a luster today, two centuries after its code was cracked?” (paragraph 15)

What is the significance of the figurative language “retain such a luster” in this excerpt?

- Ⓐ It indicates how well people have preserved the stone.
- Ⓑ It explains the specific information revealed by the stone.
- Ⓒ It shows how some people wonder about the stone’s future.
- Ⓓ It suggests that the stone’s attraction goes beyond translation.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 39%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Explain the meaning and/or significance of rhetorical devices in a text.

- 6.** This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the author's purpose in paragraphs 11–12?

- ☒ Ⓐ to establish the significance of the discovery
- ☐ Ⓑ to reveal how the ancient languages are used today
- ☐ Ⓒ to tell about the men who first discovered the Rosetta Stone
- ☐ Ⓓ to provide details about the kinds of ancient objects found in Egypt

Part B

What does the author do to support the purpose in Part A?

- ☐ Ⓐ describes Champollion's strong work ethic
- ☐ Ⓑ points out the time period Champollion lived in
- ☐ Ⓒ describes the languages Champollion had mastered
- ☒ Ⓓ points out Champollion's excitement about his success

Answer Key: A and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain how an author establishes and achieves purpose(s) through diction and syntax.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

7. How does the section **A decree of loyalty** contribute to the development of ideas in the passage?
- Ⓐ It recounts how the stone was finally discovered.
 - Ⓑ It presents different interpretations of the writing on the stone.
 - Ⓒ It offers background information about the purpose of the stone.
 - Ⓓ It explains how people are still looking for similar stones in other places.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey a purpose in texts.

Hearts and Hands

by O. Henry

This story takes place on a passenger train in the western United States in the early 1900s. Around this time, traveling by train was the most reliable and popular way to travel long distances.

- 1 At Denver there was an influx of passengers into the coaches on the eastbound B. & M. express. In one coach there sat a very pretty young woman dressed in elegant taste and surrounded by all the luxurious comforts of an experienced traveler. Among the newcomers were two young men, one of handsome presence with a bold, frank countenance and manner; the other a ruffled, glum-faced person, heavily built and roughly dressed. The two were handcuffed together.
- 2 As they passed down the aisle of the coach the only vacant seat offered was a reversed one facing the attractive young woman. Here the linked couple seated themselves. The young woman's glance fell upon them with a distant, swift disinterest; then with a lovely smile brightening her countenance and a tender pink tingeing her rounded cheeks, she held out a little gray-gloved hand. When she spoke her voice, full, sweet, and deliberate, proclaimed that its owner was accustomed to speak and be heard.
- 3 "Well, Mr. Easton, if you will make me speak first, I suppose I must. Don't you ever recognize old friends when you meet them in the West?"
- 4 The younger man roused himself sharply at the sound of her voice, seemed to struggle with a slight embarrassment which he threw off instantly, and then clasped her fingers with his left hand.
- 5 "It's Miss Fairchild," he said, with a smile. "I'll ask you to excuse the other hand; it's otherwise engaged just at present."
- 6 He slightly raised his right hand, bound at the wrist by the shining "bracelet" to the left one of his companion. The glad look in the girl's eyes slowly changed to a bewildered horror. The glow faded from her cheeks. Her lips parted in a vague, relaxing distress. Easton, with a little laugh, as if amused, was about to speak again when the other forestalled him. The glum-faced man had been watching the girl's countenance with veiled glances from his keen, shrewd eyes.
- 7 "You'll excuse me for speaking, miss, but, I see you're acquainted with the marshal here. If you'll ask him to speak a word for me when we get to the pen he'll do it, and it'll make things easier for me there. He's taking me to Leavenworth prison. It's seven years for counterfeiting."

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 8 "Oh!" said the girl, with a deep breath and returning color. "So that is what you are doing out here? A marshal!"
- 9 "My dear Miss Fairchild," said Easton, calmly, "I had to do something. Money has a way of taking wings unto itself, and you know it takes money to keep step with our crowd in Washington. I saw this opening in the West, and—well, a marshalship isn't quite as high a position as that of ambassador, but—"
- 10 "The ambassador," said the girl, warmly, "doesn't call any more. He needn't ever have done so. You ought to know that. And so now you are one of these dashing Western heroes, and you ride . . . and go into all kinds of dangers. That's different from the Washington life. You have been missed from the old crowd."
- 11 The girl's eyes, fascinated, went back, widening a little, to rest upon the glittering handcuffs.
- 12 "Don't you worry about them, miss," said the other man. "All marshals handcuff themselves to their prisoners to keep them from getting away. Mr. Easton knows his business."
- 13 "Will we see you again soon in Washington?" asked the girl.
- 14 "Not soon, I think," said Easton. "My butterfly days are over, I fear."
- 15 "I love the West," said the girl irrelevantly. Her eyes were shining softly. She looked away out the car window. She began to speak truly and simply without the gloss of style and manner: "Mamma and I spent the summer in Denver. She went home a week ago because father was slightly ill. I could live and be happy in the West. I think the air here agrees with me. Money isn't everything. But people always misunderstand things and remain stupid—"
- 16 "Say, Mr. Marshal," growled the glum-faced man. "This isn't quite fair. . . . Haven't you talked long enough?" . . .
- 17 The bound travelers rose to their feet, Easton with the same slow smile on his face.
- 18 . . . "Good-bye, Miss Fairchild. Duty calls, you know." He held out his hand for a farewell.
- 19 "It's too bad you are not going East," she said, reclothing herself with manner and style. "But you must go on to Leavenworth, I suppose?"
- 20 "Yes," said Easton, "I must go on to Leavenworth."
- 21 The two men sidled down the aisle. . . .
- 22 The two passengers in a seat near by had heard most of the conversation. Said one of them: "That marshal's a good sort of chap. Some of these Western fellows are all right."

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 23 “Pretty young to hold an office like that, isn’t he?” asked the other.
- 24 “Young!” exclaimed the first speaker, “why—Oh! didn’t you catch on? Say—did you ever know an officer to handcuff a prisoner to his right hand?”

Excerpt from “Hearts and Hands” by O. Henry. In the public domain.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

8. How does the historical setting impact the plot of the passage?

- Ⓐ It creates a conflict about women working on trains.
- Ⓑ It supports the attitudes of adventure about the West.
- Ⓒ It offers a comparison between people who travel often.
- Ⓓ It suggests the lack of possibilities for success in the West.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of setting on character development and plot in a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

9. Complete the table to show how the different elements of the train affect character development in the passage.

	The Crowded Coach	The Long Journey	Both
allows characters to separate at different places	(A)	(B)	(C)
forces multiple characters into close contact	(D)	(E)	(F)
creates an environment different from what some characters are used to	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: B, D, I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of setting on character development and plot in a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

10. How do the two questions in paragraph 24 affect the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ They reveal that Mr. Easton is a foolish man.
- Ⓑ They imply that the glum-faced man is truly guilty.
- Ⓒ They clarify that Mr. Easton is actually the prisoner.
- Ⓓ They suggest that the glum-faced man is a pitiful character.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Explain the meaning and/or significance of rhetorical devices in a text.

11. How does the third-person narrator influence the passage?

- Ⓐ by describing the way that Miss Fairchild avoids Mr. Easton on the train
- Ⓑ by suggesting that Mr. Easton and Miss Fairchild both want to leave the West
- Ⓒ by hiding the true relationship between Mr. Easton and the glum-faced man until the end
- Ⓓ by providing conflicting knowledge of where Mr. Easton and the glum-faced man are traveling to

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the influence of narrator(s), including unreliable narrator(s), and/or shifts in point of view in a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

12. How does the passage develop the themes of enjoying the company of old friends and the fun of experiencing new places?

- Ⓐ through Miss Fairchild's discomfort at being in the marshal's presence
- Ⓑ through Mr. Easton's eagerness to learn about Miss Fairchild's family trip
- Ⓒ through Mr. Easton's reluctance to sit close to such an elegant passenger
- Ⓓ through Miss Fairchild's delight at chatting with Mr. Easton on her journey home

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Compare two or more themes and their development throughout a literary text.

13. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What are **two** themes of the passage?

- Ⓐ Knowledge of the truth can bring freedom.
- Ⓑ Adventure is important to living a happy life.
- Ⓒ Material objects are desired by many people.
- Ⓓ Things can be different from how they appear.
- Ⓔ A simple conversation may contain hidden truths.

Part B

How does the author develop the themes in Part A?

- Ⓐ through the interactions of Mr. Easton, Miss Fairchild, and the glum-faced man
- Ⓑ through Miss Fairchild's reflection on the summer she spent exploring the West
- Ⓒ through the discussion of the glum-faced man's expectations of Leavenworth prison
- Ⓓ through the contrast between the destinations of Mr. Easton, Miss Fairchild, and the glum-faced man

Answer Key: D, E and A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 24%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Compare two or more themes and their development throughout a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

14. Select **two** details that show how the narrator suggests that Miss Fairchild is used to being treated well.

- Ⓐ "In one coach there sat a very pretty young woman dressed in elegant taste and surrounded by all the luxurious comforts of an experienced traveler." (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ "When she spoke her voice, full, sweet, and deliberate, proclaimed that its owner was accustomed to speak and be heard." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "'Oh!' said the girl, with a deep breath and returning color." (paragraph 8)
- Ⓓ "'The ambassador,' said the girl, warmly, 'doesn't call any more.'" (paragraph 10)
- Ⓔ "The girl's eyes, fascinated, went back, widening a little, to rest upon the glittering handcuffs." (paragraph 11)

Answer Key: A, B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the influence of narrator(s), including unreliable narrator(s), and/or shifts in point of view in a literary text.

Passage 1: Easy for you, tough for a robot

by Kathryn Hulick

1 “Robots are klutzes,” says Ken Goldberg. He’s an engineer and artificial intelligence (AI) expert at the University of California, Berkeley. A computer can easily defeat a human grandmaster at the game of chess by coming up with better moves. Yet a robot has trouble picking up an actual chess piece.

2 This is an example of Moravec’s paradox. Hans Moravec is a roboticist at Carnegie Mellon University in Pittsburgh, Penn., who also writes about AI and the future. Back in 1988, he wrote a book that noted how reasoning tasks that seem hard to people are fairly easy to program into computers. Meanwhile, many tasks that come easily to us—like moving around, seeing or grasping things—are quite hard to program.

3 It’s “difficult or impossible” for a computer to match a one-year-old baby’s skills in these areas, he wrote. Though computers have advanced by leaps and bounds since then, babies and kids still beat machines at these types of tasks.

4 It turns out that the tasks we find easy aren’t really “easy” at all. As you walk around your house or pick up and move a chess piece, your brain is performing incredible feats of calculation and coordination. You just don’t notice it because you do it without thinking.

5 Let’s take a look at several tasks that are easy for kids but not for robots. For each one, we’ll find out why the task is actually so hard. We’ll also learn about the brilliant work engineers and computer scientists are doing to design new AI that should help robots up their game.

Task 1: Pick stuff up

6 Goldberg has something in common with robots. He, too, is a klutz. “I was the worst kid at sports. If you threw me a ball, I was sure to drop it,” he says. Perhaps, he ponders, that’s why he wound up studying robotic grasping. Maybe he’d figure out the secret to holding onto things.

7 He’s discovered that robots (and clumsy humans) face three challenges in grabbing an object. Number one is perception. That’s the ability to see an object and figure out where it is in space. Cameras and sensors that measure distance have gotten much better at this in recent years. But robots still get confused by anything “shiny or transparent,” he notes. . . .

Task 2: Get around the world

8 If someone plops you down in the middle of a building you’ve never been in before, you might feel a bit lost. But you could look around,

find a door and get out of the room quickly without bumping into anything or getting stuck. Most robots could not do that. Researcher Antoni Rosinol first got interested in this problem while working with drones. Usually, someone pilots a drone via remote control. That's because most drones can't fly very well by themselves. "They can barely go forward without colliding against a tree," notes Rosinol. He is a PhD student studying computer vision at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in Cambridge.

- 9 Perception is a big problem for many navigating robots, just as it is for robots that grasp things. . . .

Task 3: Understand people

- 10 No matter what a robot tries to do, one big thing holds it back. Robots lack common sense. This is the knowledge that people don't have to think or talk about because it's so obvious to us. Thanks to common sense, you know that you should grab a lollipop by the stick and not by the candy. You know that doors are almost never located on the floor or ceiling. And so on.
- 11 Computer scientists have tried teaching robots common-sense rules. But even huge databases of these rules don't seem to help much. There are just too many rules and too many exceptions. And no computer or robot understands the world well enough to figure out these rules on its own. . . .
- 12 It's very likely that in the coming years someone will design a graceful robot or even an AI model with common sense. For now, though, if you want to beat a robot at chess, make it play on a real, physical chess board.

Excerpt from "Easy for you, tough for a robot" by Kathryn Hulick, from *Science News Explores*. Copyright © 2021 by Society for Science & the Public. Reprinted by permission of Society for Science & the Public via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: from *How Life Imitates Chess*

by Garry Kasparov

In 1996 and 1997, World Chess Champion Garry Kasparov played two chess matches against a supercomputer named Deep Blue, created by the company IBM. The matches placed Kasparov's intelligence against the computer's artificial intelligence.

- 13 After my first match with Deep Blue in 1996 in Philadelphia received so much publicity, IBM threw its full weight behind a six-game rematch in May 1997 to be held in downtown Manhattan. In 1996, I

lost the first game of the match, but after that wake-up call I came back to win three games and easily defeat the computer 4–2. For the rematch IBM claimed “Deeper Blue” was twice as fast and much smarter. They had hired human Grandmasters to work full-time “teaching” the computer by improving its evaluation function.

- 14 The media attention for the first game of the rematch was beyond that of a world championship. Over three hundred journalists were accredited, and the five-hundred-seat auditorium sold out at \$25 per ticket. Of course I was nervous. Being human, I was unable to ignore all of these distractions, unlike my silicon¹ opponent. But I played well enough to win the first game with white². The second game would, however, change the course of the match, and of human-machine competition.
- 15 I’ve talked about computers and their inability to make long-term plans. They calculate variations in a linear way, examining each move in turn, searching deeper and deeper. Even at Deep Blue’s 200 million moves per second, it took it a long time to see far enough ahead to play competent strategic chess. It would occasionally make silly moves no strong human would consider, and it did this in its loss in game one. Game two was an entirely different matter. . . . Instead of going for a short-term advantage, it closed in for the kill. Faced with a losing position and stunned by the godlike quality of the machine’s play, I resigned.
- 16 I soon received an even greater shock. It turned out that the final position of the second game was not a losing one for me after all. With its last move the computer had blundered, and I had resigned in a drawn position! It felt like being kicked in the stomach after already being knocked down. When I was shown the drawing line, I realized that I would have continued on against any human. . . .
- 17 I missed a clear win in the fourth game, and by then I was exhausted and confused. Was something fishy going on, or was Deep Blue really so strong? In the fifth game I again missed good winning chances, so the match remained tied with one win apiece and three draws. Everything was set for a showdown in game six, but looking back today, I see my fate had already been sealed.
- 18 It took only nineteen moves for me to resign the worst game of my career and lose the match. I was simply in no condition to play chess by that point, and I made an infantile blunder in the opening. After a few more feeble moves the game and the match were over. I was ashamed of my performance and for letting the mysterious second game get to me.

¹silicon: a chemical element used to make many electronic devices

²white: in chess, game pieces are white or black in color

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

15. Select **two** details where the author’s word choice reveals a negative view toward the abilities of robots.

- 6 Ⓐ Goldberg has something in common with robots. He, too, is a klutz. Ⓑ “I was the worst kid at sports. If you threw me a ball, I was sure to drop it,” he says. Ⓒ Perhaps, he ponders, that’s why he wound up studying robotic grasping. Ⓓ Maybe he’d figure out the secret to holding onto things.
- 7 Ⓔ He’s discovered that robots (and clumsy humans) face three challenges in grabbing an object. Ⓕ Number one is perception. Ⓖ That’s the ability to see an object and figure out where it is in space. Ⓗ Cameras and sensors that measure distance have gotten much better at this in recent years. ⓘ But robots still get confused by anything “shiny or transparent,” he notes. . . .

Answer Key: A, E, or I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 56%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain how an author establishes and achieves purpose(s) through diction and syntax.

- 16.** How does the author develop an argument against robot intelligence in paragraph 10 of Passage 1?
- Ⓐ by suggesting that robots are only able to copy what they see humans do
 - Ⓑ by describing how robots complete tasks in more difficult ways than humans do
 - Ⓒ by explaining ways in which humans are taught to overcome unfamiliar situations
 - Ⓓ by providing examples of how humans can do certain things without being taught

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, analyzing the types of reasoning used and their effectiveness.

17. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“We’ll also learn about the brilliant work engineers and computer scientists are doing to design new AI that should help robots up their game.” (paragraph 5)

How does the figurative language in this sentence impact the meaning of the passage?

- ☒ Ⓐ It indicates that people are finding ways to make robots better.
- ☐ Ⓑ It demonstrates the fun that people can have while using robots.
- ☐ Ⓒ It emphasizes the amount of effort that goes into building robots.
- ☐ Ⓓ It suggests that people who build robots compete with one another.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 70%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning and explain examples of allusions in text(s).

18. How does the author of Passage 1 support the claim that robots struggle at tasks that are easy for humans?

- ☒ Ⓐ by citing experts and their experiences working with robots
- ☐ Ⓑ by demonstrating how experts use robots in their personal lives
- ☐ Ⓒ by describing how experts feel while creating robots that perform simple tasks
- ☐ Ⓓ by identifying experts and their paths to becoming respected in the field of robotics

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, analyzing the types of reasoning used and their effectiveness.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

19. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“I’ve talked about computers and their inability to make long-term plans.” (paragraph 15)

Match the correct meaning of the prefix, root, and suffix to define the word inability as it is used in this sentence.

	in-	abil	-ity
power	(A)	(B)	(C)
lack of	(D)	(E)	(F)
the state of	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: B, D, I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

20. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“It felt like being kicked in the stomach after already being knocked down.” (paragraph 16)

How does the figurative language in this sentence impact the tone of the passage?

- Ⓐ It develops a sense of chaos.
- Ⓑ It creates a feeling of jealousy.
- Ⓒ It highlights the feeling of tension.
- Ⓓ It emphasizes the sense of defeat.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning and explain examples of allusions in text(s).

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 21.** Why does the author of Passage 2 use the phrase “teaching’ the computer” in paragraph 13?
- Ⓐ to reveal the amount of time it takes to set up computers
 - Ⓑ to reveal the data collected from the development of computers
 - Ⓒ to highlight how computers can help people develop useful skills
 - Ⓓ to emphasize that computers must be programmed in order to advance

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain how an author establishes and achieves purpose(s) through diction and syntax.

22. Read these sentences from Passage 2.

“I missed a clear win in the fourth game, and by then I was exhausted and confused. Was something fishy going on, or was Deep Blue really so strong?” (paragraph 17)

How does the author’s use of the phrase “something fishy going on” in paragraph 17 add to Passage 2?

- Ⓐ by indicating that he had considered trying to trick Deep Blue
- Ⓑ by showing how impressed he was by Deep Blue’s physical power
- Ⓒ by expressing how overwhelmed he was by Deep Blue’s playing abilities
- Ⓓ by suggesting that he became uninterested in playing against Deep Blue

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain how an author establishes and achieves purpose(s) through diction and syntax.

23. Passage 2 develops these two central ideas.

1. The human brain has a limit.
2. Technology is able to make humans question their abilities.

How does the author develop these two ideas?

- Ⓐ by identifying the skills required to play chess successfully
- Ⓑ by describing how interested the public was in the matches
- Ⓒ by explaining how Deep Blue was trained before the rematch
- Ⓓ by stating the outcomes of various chess games with Deep Blue

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Compare two or more central ideas and their development throughout a text.

24. How does paragraph 18 contribute to the meaning of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ It emphasizes the annoyance the author felt toward Deep Blue.
- Ⓑ It reveals the plan Deep Blue followed in order to win the match.
- Ⓒ It stresses the humiliation that the author felt after losing to Deep Blue.
- Ⓓ It compares the strategies that Deep Blue and the author used during the match.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 66%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey a purpose in texts.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 25.** Complete the table to show whether each perspective about robot capabilities applies to Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
Robots can accomplish amazing things.	(A)	(B)	(C)
Robots can surprise people by outsmarting them.	(D)	(E)	(F)
Robots lack the common sense that humans have.	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: C, E, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how authors with differing perspectives address the same or related topics or themes.

Passage 1: The Lighthouse Birds

1 Thick mist from the ocean sprayed on the breeze as Aurora walked down the rickety boardwalk. In the distance, outlined against the frothy white waves of the sea, stood a large red lighthouse. Well, the color resembled a chewed piece of bubble gum now, long since faded and washed out from the sun. The wooden boardwalk leading to the building had seen better days, too. Aurora didn't mind—she'd journey anywhere to capture a good story.

2 “No wonder they want to tear this place down—it’s not exactly easy on the eyes,” her co-editor Harrison complained, sidestepping what was once someone’s picnic lunch.

3 Aurora sighed as they drew closer to the lighthouse. “Honeydew Lighthouse used to be the most gorgeous place on Honeydew Key. Did you know they built it in 1920? It’s over a hundred years old.”

4 “What happened to it?” Harrison asked, eyebrows raised in disbelief. Aurora had to admit, looking at the lighthouse now, it was hard to believe it was ever a shining beacon of the community, attracting tourists for its unbeatable views of the sea.

5 “As the town grew, new tourist attractions popped up—there’s that outlet mall, and the miniature golf course. I guess people are more interested in those things,” Aurora said sadly.

6 “Can you blame them?” Harrison asked. “Miniature golf is awesome, and this lighthouse is, well . . .” He trailed off, clearly not wanting to hurt Aurora’s feelings.

7 Harrison’s disdain for the lighthouse only reminded Aurora of the email she’d received a few days ago from the keeper of the Honeydew Lighthouse.

Aurora,

I read all your news stories in the local paper. I ask that you write a piece imploring the city to reconsider tearing down Honeydew Lighthouse. It is a cornerstone of history, and it deserves to remain standing.

Best,

William Washington

8 She had walked out of her office after reading the email and walked down to the beach to think. The rough, sandy shore and salty air helped clear her mind. Whenever she was feeling stumped, the crystal blue water gave her clarity and reminded her why she so deeply loved Honeydew Key.

- 9 Pulling out her phone, she began researching ideas for how to save the lighthouse. She considered starting a petition or trying to get the lighthouse named a historic landmark. There was no guarantee that either of those approaches would be successful, however, and they would be time-consuming, dragging on for months, if not years. Aurora wasn't sure she had that kind of time. They could save the lighthouse if there were endangered or protected animal species living there, but that seemed unlikely.
- 10 No, her best approach would be to talk to Mr. Washington in person and rally the town's support. This is how she ended up dragging Harrison reluctantly down the boardwalk toward Honeydew Lighthouse. She now noticed Mr. Washington at the top, attempting to repaint the peeling sides. He waved to Aurora and Harrison before suddenly disappearing into the lighthouse. When the pair reached the base of the building, a small door swung open. "Thank you both for coming," Mr. Washington said as he ushered them inside.
- 11 As the group climbed the creaking staircase, the trilling sound of birds echoed off the walls. "Since the city has allocated its budget to renovate the downtown area for tourists, there is no money for me to restore Honeydew Lighthouse."
- 12 The sound of birds grew louder the higher they climbed, and Harrison showed Aurora a face that screamed, "Seriously? You want to save a place overrun by birds?"
- 13 "This lighthouse is the reason for the town. Before all this new technology, it was the only way to guide ships," Mr. Washington explained proudly.
- 14 As they reached the top of the lighthouse, the source of all the bird noise came into view. About a dozen white birds roosted around the ceiling, feathers ruffling in the ocean breeze.
- 15 "I recognize that bird," Harrison said excitedly, "It's a Roseate Tern—did you know that they're endangered?"
- 16 Silence fell over the group as sudden realization dawned on Aurora.
- 17 "Harrison, you may not love this lighthouse, but you are a genius!"
- 18 "I am?" His nose scrunched in confusion, unaware of what he had done.
- 19 "I know how to write my news article. We can save Honeydew Lighthouse!"

"The Lighthouse Birds" written for educational purposes.

Passage 2: Do Not Go Gentle Into That Good Night

by Dylan Thomas

- 1 Do not go gentle into that good night,
Old age should burn and rave at close of day;
Rage, rage against the dying of the light.
- 5 Though wise men at their end know dark is right,
Because their words had forked no lightning they
Do not go gentle into that good night.
- Good men, the last wave by, crying how bright
Their frail deeds might have danced in a green bay,
Rage, rage against the dying of the light.
- 10 Wild men who caught and sang the sun in flight,
And learn, too late, they grieved it on its way,
Do not go gentle into that good night.
- Grave men, near death, who see with blinding sight
Blind eyes could blaze like meteors and be gay,
15 Rage, rage against the dying of the light.
- And you, my father, there on the sad height,
Curse, bless, me now with your fierce tears, I pray.
Do not go gentle into that good night.
Rage, rage against the dying of the light.

"Do Not Go Gentle Into That Good Night" by Dylan Thomas. Copyright © 1957 by New Directions Publishing Corporation. Reprinted by permission of New Directions Publishing Corporation via Copyright Clearance Center.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

26. How would Passage 1 address the story differently if it were told from the point of view of Harrison?

- Ⓐ by describing the scenery where the lighthouse is located
- Ⓑ by identifying what makes the lighthouse special to the community
- Ⓒ by showing how the age of the lighthouse means it should be updated
- Ⓓ by explaining that there are good reasons for tearing down the lighthouse

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the influence of narrator(s), including unreliable narrator(s), and/or shifts in point of view in a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

27. Complete the table to match each rhetorical device from Passage 1 with its meaning.

	Pleasant to Look At	In Older and Poor Condition	Experiencing Confusion
"had seen better days" (paragraph 1)	(A)	(B)	(C)
"easy on the eyes" (paragraph 2)	(D)	(E)	(F)
"feeling stumped" (paragraph 8)	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: B, D, I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Explain the meaning and/or significance of rhetorical devices in a text.

28. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“This is how she ended up dragging Harrison reluctantly down the boardwalk toward Honeydew Lighthouse.” (paragraph 10)

The word “reluctant” is from a Latin root that means “to struggle.” Based on this information, what does the word reluctantly mean in this sentence?

- ☒ Ⓐ in an unwilling or hesitant way
- ☐ Ⓑ with feelings of anger or despair
- ☐ Ⓒ with eagerness to take on a challenge
- ☐ Ⓓ in confusion caused by unclear directions

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 29.** Complete the table to show how the features of the setting affect the plot of Passage 1.

	Contributes to the Main Problem	Provides the Solution
The lighthouse is old and in need of repair.	(A)	(B)
An endangered bird species lives at the lighthouse.	(C)	(D)
The town has other attractions that are more popular than the lighthouse.	(E)	(F)

Answer Key: A, D, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of setting on character development and plot in a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

30. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

"I ask that you write a piece imploring the city to reconsider tearing down Honeydew Lighthouse." (paragraph 7)

What is the meaning of the word imploring as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ admiring
- Ⓑ begging
- Ⓒ enclosing
- Ⓓ visiting

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

31. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“Since the city has allocated its budget to renovate the downtown area for tourists, there is no money for me to restore Honeydew Lighthouse.”
(paragraph 11)

What is the meaning of the word allocated in this sentence?

- Ⓐ cast doubt upon
- Ⓑ set aside for a purpose
- Ⓒ sacrificed in a quick decision
- Ⓓ borrowed without expecting repayment

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

32. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What does the setting of Passage 1 reveal about William Washington?

- Ⓐ his skill in conducting research
- Ⓑ his hesitation in asking for help
- Ⓒ his pride in protecting the lighthouse
- Ⓓ his exhaustion from working by himself

Part B

Which sentence from Passage 1 supports the answer in Part A?

- Ⓐ *"I read all your news stories in the local paper."* (paragraph 7)
- Ⓑ *"It is a cornerstone of history, and it deserves to remain standing."* (paragraph 7)
- Ⓒ *"No, her best approach would be to talk to Mr. Washington in person and rally the town's support."* (paragraph 10)
- Ⓓ *"'Thank you both for coming,' Mr. Washington said as he ushered them inside."* (paragraph 10)

Answer Key: C and B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of setting on character development and plot in a literary text.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 33.** Complete the table to show whether the figurative language in the lines from Passage 2 describes youth or old age.

	Youth	Old Age
"caught and sang the sun in flight" (line 10)	(A)	(B)
"there on the sad height" (line 16)	(C)	(D)
"the dying of the light" (line 19)	(E)	(F)

Answer Key: A, D, F

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning and explain examples of allusions in text(s).

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

34. How does the repetition of lines 1 and 3 throughout Passage 2 affect the meaning of the poem?

- Ⓐ It shows that the speaker is afraid of life's difficulties.
- Ⓑ It explains why the speaker wants to change his past choices.
- Ⓒ It describes doubts the speaker has about his father's decisions.
- Ⓓ It emphasizes the strength the speaker wants his father to have.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of various poetic forms on meaning and style.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

- 35.** Complete the table to match the details from the passages to how they develop the topic of refusing to give up.

	Encourages a person to show strength.	Takes inspiration from an opposing viewpoint.
“Harrison, you may not love this lighthouse, but you are a genius!” (Passage 1, paragraph 17)	(A)	(B)
“Old age should burn and rave at close of day;” (Passage 2, line 2)	(C)	(D)

Answer Key: B, C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 66%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how authors with differing perspectives address the same or related topics or themes.

Grade 7 FAST ELA Reading Test Release Support Document

36. How does the author of Passage 1 develop the topic of facing a challenge differently than the author of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ In Passage 1, Aurora fights on behalf of others, but in Passage 2, the speaker acts selfishly.
- Ⓑ In Passage 1, Aurora confronts a difficulty herself, but in Passage 2, the speaker is an observer.
- Ⓒ In Passage 1, Aurora works independently, but in Passage 2, the speaker joins a group of people.
- Ⓓ In Passage 1, Aurora feels troubled by her experiences, but in Passage 2, the speaker remains cheerful.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.7.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how authors with differing perspectives address the same or related topics or themes.